

Manufacturing / Distribution SMB

Information Protection MVP for sellers, architects, and technical specialists

Supply chain & design IP

Protect supplier contracts, pricing, CAD/BOM documents, and design IP

Highest consulting value

Built-in SITs first, then custom detection for IP-heavy workflows

Built-in ready

Tax IDs, bank details, and shipping/customs docs covered by built-in SITs

HOW TO READ THE EXAMPLES

The boxes below show common privacy, supply-chain, design-IP, and records requirements in Manufacturing / Distribution.

CHEMICALS & MATERIALS

Formulations, batch records, SDS sheets, quality-control files

AGRIBUSINESS

Crop data, feed specs, supply-chain records, regulatory filings

INDUSTRIAL MACHINERY

CAD drawings, bills of materials, engineering specs, assembly docs

HIGH TECH ELECTRONICS

Product specs, firmware files, component data, warranty records

SEMICONDUCTOR

Design files, fabrication specs, IP documentation, test records

Why it matters for Manufacturing / Distribution SMBs

Supplier contracts, pricing grids, CAD drawings, bills of materials, design IP, and shipping records move through Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive every day — often across suppliers, distributors, OEM partners, freight carriers, and regulatory agencies.

This MVP helps teams protect high-value business data and design IP in Microsoft 365 within 30 days while keeping day-to-day collaboration moving with trusted external partners.

Partner service motion (30–90 day path)

- ① On demand learning — [Implement Microsoft Purview Information Protection \(Microsoft Learn\)](#)
- ② Deploy — pilot on Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive · Pilot (Partner-led) · 2–4 weeks
- ③ Govern sharing — trusted external controls · Expansion (Partner-led) · 4–6 weeks
- ④ Managed service — tuning, data loss prevention, audit evidence · Ongoing (Partner-led)

LICENSING: BUSINESS PREMIUM + PURVIEW SUITE ADD-ON

Included in Business Premium (MVP)

- ✓ Manual + default sensitivity labels
- ✓ Built-in sensitive information types
- ✓ Data loss prevention for Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive
- ✓ Basic audit (180-day retention)
- ✓ Controlled external sharing

Purview Suite for Business Premium (Phase 2)

- ✓ Auto-labeling policies based on content and context
- ✓ Custom sensitive information types, exact data match, trainable classifiers
- ✓ Advanced data loss prevention for endpoints, Teams, and browsers
- ✓ Audit (Premium) (1-year retention, search)
- ✓ Insider Risk Management and Records Management
- ✓ Data Lifecycle Management
- ✓ Information Barriers
- ✓ Communication Compliance

RECOMMENDED FIRST CUSTOMER MOTION — 30-DAY MVP

1 DISCOVER (WEEK 1)

Map supplier contract locations, design-IP repositories, distribution and logistics partner sharing, and HR hot spots. 60-minute discovery workshop.

2 DEPLOY (WEEKS 2–3)

Publish the 5-label model. Pilot on Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive. Turn on built-in detection, default labels, and controlled external sharing for suppliers and partners.

3 PROVE (WEEK 4)

Create an evidence pack showing labeled content, remediated risky sharing, and encrypted design-IP and HR files. Prepare Phase 2 options such as endpoint coverage, broader data loss prevention, and custom part or design identifiers if needed.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES — 30 / 60 / 90 DAY CHECKPOINTS

30 days FOUNDATION (MICROSOFT-DELIVERED ASSETS)

- ✓ 5-label model live on Exchange, SharePoint, and OneDrive
- ✓ Built-in detection covering supplier and employee data in files
- ✓ Default labels applied to new content
- ✓ HR/payroll files encrypted with Highly Confidential

60 days CONTROLLED SHARING (Partner service opportunity)

- ✓ External sharing policies for suppliers, distributors, and OEM partners
- ✓ Quality and safety files under watermarking and encryption
- ✓ Supplier specs and contracts on auto-expire links
- ✓ Alerts on design-IP exports leaving the organization

90 days EXPAND (Partner service opportunity)

- ✓ Audit evidence pack for ISO, regulatory, and compliance readiness reviews
- ✓ Custom detection for part numbers or design IDs if the data model needs it
- ✓ Endpoint labeling for plant-floor and field-service teams
- ✓ Decision point on Purview Suite for Business Premium for more automation and governance

Talk track for sellers, architects & specialists “Manufacturing and Distribution SMBs need practical protection for supplier contracts, design IP, pricing, and bills of materials while still collaborating with suppliers, distributors, OEM partners, and logistics providers. Purview lets them start with built-in detection and controlled external sharing now, then add custom part or design identifiers only if the data model requires it.”	Discovery questions (Manufacturing / Distribution) • Where do supplier records live — ERP, procurement systems, SharePoint sites, or file shares? • Which suppliers, distributors, OEM partners, or logistics providers collaborate on contracts, pricing, or specs? • Do you share CAD drawings, bills of materials, or formulations with contract manufacturers or design partners? • Are there part numbers, design IDs, or BOM identifiers that built-in detection will not catch? • Who owns quality, safety, or HR files — and where are they stored?	Handle common objections “We’re too small for this.” Business Premium already supports a practical 30-day starting point with built-in detection and labeling. “NDAs already cover us.” NDAs do not stop accidental forwards or overshared links — controlled sharing does. “Will this slow my users?” Default labels and built-in detection keep the pilot lightweight for end users. Recommended next step Run a 60-minute workshop to identify high-value data, external-sharing workflows, and the scope for a 30-day pilot.
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TOP DATA TYPES, LABEL FIT, AND EXAMPLE CUSTOMER MOTION

Workflow or Content	High-Value Data (Built-in / Label-Led / Custom)	Starting Label	MVP Guidance
Supplier management, procurement & contract workflows	Built-in: Supplier names, tax IDs, bank details, address, payment data	CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Start with built-in Microsoft detection; protect supplier and procurement records first.
OEM partner, distributor & logistics provider collaboration	Label-led: Supplier contracts, pricing grids, distribution agreements, logistics partner specs, RFQ responses	CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Controlled external sharing for trusted partner workflows; block unmanaged forwards.
Payroll, HR, complaint & incident files	Built-in: Tax IDs, bank details, salary data, employee case information	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Strong early proof point for encryption and tighter access control.
Design, engineering & product development	Label-led: CAD drawings, bills of materials, engineering specs, product development plans, formulations	CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Start with content labeling and default labels, then add contextual rules later if needed.
Quality, safety & regulatory compliance	Built-in: SDS sheets, batch records, recall files, regulatory filings, compliance audit reports	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Apply encryption and watermarking, with tightly scoped permissions for quality, safety, and compliance teams.
Contract manufacturer & supplier spec exchange	Label-led: Formulations, sourcing specs, tooling drawings, supplier audit packs, co-manufacturing agreements	CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Controlled external sharing with trusted externals; auto-expiring links.
Published product collateral & marketing materials	Published product catalogs, approved brochures, public technical specifications, trade-show materials	PUBLIC	Keep external-ready content easy to share and clearly separated.
Internal operations & team coordination	Label-led: Meeting notes, internal project briefs, team SOPs, non-sensitive supplier comms	GENERAL	Apply as the default email label; keep routine internal content lightly marked and easy to find.
ERP-integrated pricing, order & fulfillment workflows	Label-led: ERP pricing feeds, order management exports, MRP outputs where encryption causes downstream breakage	CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	Use only when encryption blocks a critical LOB workflow; document the exception and review quarterly.
Quality management & compliance tooling workflows	Label-led: QMS-integrated records, regulatory-reporting feeds, or safety-system exports where HC encryption breaks critical tooling	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	Exception path only; marking without encryption. Requires IT sign-off and quarterly justification review.
Phase 2 expansion	Custom if needed: Part numbers, design IDs, BOM identifiers, contract reference numbers	HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Add custom detection or exact data match only if the data model requires it.

RECOMMENDED 8-LABEL DEFEND-ALIGNED MODEL FOR MANUFACTURING SMB

Label	Manufacturing / Distribution Example Content	Protection Baseline
PUBLIC	Published product catalogs, approved brochures, public technical specifications	No encryption; external sharing allowed
GENERAL	Internal SOPs, routine supplier coordination, low-risk operating docs	No encryption; internal marking only. Default email label.
CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Supplier records, procurement files, pricing grids, CAD drawings, BOMs, engineering development plans	Marking + encryption; no external sharing. Default document label.
CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Distributor contracts, OEM partner specs, logistics provider agreements, auditor diligence, supplier audit packs	Named-user permissions for trusted externals; governed external sharing required.
CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	LOB or legacy workflows where encryption breaks ERP integrations, MRP systems, or partner portals	Marking only; no external sharing. Exception path; requires justification.
HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ ALL EMPLOYEES	Payroll, incident files, recall records, regulatory filings, SDS sheets, formulations, design trade secrets	Strong encryption, watermark, block unmanaged sharing; no external access.
HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ SPECIFIC PEOPLE	Regulator responses, legal holds, auditor diligence packs requiring trusted external access	Explicit named-user access only; auto-labeling via SITs recommended.
HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL \ INTERNAL EXCEPTION	Critical workflows where HC encryption breaks quality or compliance tooling	Marking only; no external sharing. Tightly controlled exception path.